

W.A.R H.A.M.S

WORLD ACCESS RETRIEVABLE HEAVY ASSAULT MODIFIABLE SUITES

THE BATTLE FOR PLANET X

Official Rulebook

*The corporations have spoken. The planet is rich. The orders are clear.
Deploy your H.A.M.S, seize every resource, and crush anyone who stands in your way.
There is no diplomacy — only Dominance.*

2–4 Players • Ages 14+ • 90–150 Minutes

Section 1 — Introduction

W.A.R H.A.M.S (World Access Retrievable Heavy Assault Modifiable Suites) — The Battle for Planet X is a sci-fi board game of corporate warfare, territorial control, and tactical betrayal for 2–4 players, ages 14+.

Each player commands a private military force — squads of heavily armed soldiers known as H.A.M.S (Heavy Assault Modifiable Suites) — deployed by a rival megacorporation to conquer a distant, resource-rich alien world. Victory belongs to the corporation that accumulates the most Dominance Points (DP) by seizing territory, harvesting resources, arming their squads with powerful Basic Armament Cards (BACs), and manipulating the battlefield through cunning Conspire Cards.

The planet has no name — not yet. At the start of each game, players collectively choose a name for their battleground. Use the following naming convention to generate an alien-sounding designation:

Suggested Planet Name Format: 2 consonants + vowel + 2 consonants + vowel, optionally followed by Roman numerals.
Examples: Nlendagru IV · Criftonba · Throskane II · Blentova IX This is just a suggestion — feel free to name your planet whatever you like!

Fight for resources. Fight for loyalty. Fight for the planet.

Detail	Value
Players	2–4
Ages	14+
Play Time	90–150 minutes

Section 2 — Components

Hex Tiles (61 total)

The planet surface is built from randomized hexagonal tiles. Each tile represents a region of terrain or a key strategic installation.

Hex Type	Border Color	Count	Description
Oil Rig	Black	3	Produces Oil (Oil Drum) resources
Power Plant	Yellow	3	Produces Electricity (Lightning Bolt) resources
Factory	Red	3	Produces Industry (Hammer) resources
Radar Dish	Blue	3	Produces Intelligence (Transmitting Wave) resources
City / Village	Green	3	Produces Local Favor (Recruit) resources
Separatist Base	Grey	3	Hostile NPC stronghold (printed numbers: 2, 4, 6)
Spaceport Drop Zone	Purple	6	Reinforcement landing sites (printed numbers: 1–6)
Terrain Hex	—	37	Open ground, forests, craters, etc.
		61	

Number Tokens (15 total)

Number Tokens are placed on resource-producing Hexes during setup to determine which Hexes produce resources on a given dice roll. Note: Separatist Bases and Spaceport Drop Zones have their numbers printed directly on the tile and do not use Number Tokens.

Number	Token Count
1	2
2	2
3	3
4	3
5	3
6	2
Total	15

Cards

Card Type	Total	Breakdown
BAC (Basic Armament Cards)	100	20 types × 5 copies
Conspire Cards	72	24 types × 3 copies

- BACs represent weapons, armor, gadgets, and upgrades equipped to your H.A.M.S.
- Conspire Cards represent political maneuvers, sabotage, intelligence operations, and tactical gambits.

Resource Tokens (5 types)

Resources are the lifeblood of your campaign. Each type is produced by its corresponding Hex.

Resource	Color	Depiction	Token	Token Colors
Oil	Black	Fuel	Oil Drum	Black on white, black border
Electricity	Yellow	Electricity Bolt	Lightning Bolt	Yellow on white, yellow border
Intelligence	Blue	Intel Operator Room	Transmitting Wave	Blue on white, blue border
Industry	Red	Industry Factory	Hammer	Red on white, red border
Local Favor	Green	Militia Base	Recruit	Green on white, green border

Dice

- 13 six-sided dice (d6) — used for combat, resource production, and event resolution.
- 1 Separatist Die (d6) — a distinct-colored d6 (grey) used as one of the 3 resource dice during Phase 1. Only this die triggers Separatist Base results: spawning at unconquered bases or Local Favor from conquered bases.

Miniatures

Component	Details
H.A.M.S Miniatures	Soldier miniatures in 4 player colors — 28 per player (enough for 4 Squads of 7 H.A.M.S each). Each mini has 5 magnetized attachment points for the equipment slots (Head, Chest, Legs, Backpack, Hands). Each soldier sits on a 40mm magnetized round base printed with a squad letter and soldier number (A1–A7, B1–B7, C1–C7, D1–D7) and bearing 3 blood-drop divots for damage tracking.
Equipment Modules	Physical miniature parts (helmets, chest plates, weapons, backpacks, leg armor) that magnetically attach to H.A.M.S minis. Each module corresponds to a BAC card type — e.g., a S.A.P (Standard Armor Plating) Helmet module, an H.C.A.R (Heavy Caliber Assault Rifle) rifle module. 8 copies of each module type exist (more than the 5 BAC cards per type, ensuring modules are available for re-equipping via the flag system). Each module has a unique sculpt per type and its abbreviation engraved on the underside for identification. When a BAC is equipped, its card is placed in the communal Equipment Display near the play area for all players to reference. The physical module on the mini is the source of truth for who has what equipped.
Separatist Miniatures	24 grey NPC soldiers — used for Separatist spawns, base defenders, and militia

Tokens & Accessories

Component	Description
Control Flags	25 small colored flag miniatures per player (one set per player color). Used to mark territorial control on hex tiles AND to mark equipped BAC types on the Equipment Display
Cargo Containers	12 numbered plastic containers 2*(1–6) placed on spaceport hexes when BACs arrive. Matching containers near the board form the Unloading Zone where BAC cards that landed on a specific space port are stored
Equipment Display	Shared area near the board where one copy of each BAC card is placed face-up as a reference. When a player equips a BAC type, place one of your Control Flags on that card to show your access. Multiple players' flags can be on the same card. Flags stay permanently — once placed, your flag is never removed, even if all your soldiers carrying that module die. It marks that you've unlocked that BAC type and can re-equip it
Damage Pegs	Small red blood-drop pegs that snap into the divots on a soldier's base. Each base holds up to 3 pegs (4th wound = death).
Bunker Tokens	Neutral fortifications placed by D.U.D.S (Deployable Unital Defense System): +1 all defense dice on hex. 1 per hex max. Any unit benefits. Destroyed by attacker winning combat on the hex
Combat Markers	2 red circular markers, each the same size as the First Player marker. Place one at the board location of each declared combat and return it after that combat is resolved.
Combat Boards	2 numbered staging boards (North and South), each with H.A.M.S positions 1–7 and matching die positions 1–7. Used to place opposing engaged soldiers and their assigned dice face-to-face while resolving combat.
Round & Player Trackers	1 shared Round Tracker and 1 color-coded tracker per player. Player trackers record current Dominance Points (DP) and whether that player has completed their turn this round.
Planet Frame	Circular board edge made of 5 interlocking cardboard puzzle pieces that snap together to form the planet boundary. All 61 Hex tiles fill the entire interior.

Section 3 — Game Setup

Follow these steps in order to prepare the battlefield.

Step 1 — Assemble the Planet Frame

Snap the 5 interlocking cardboard puzzle pieces together to form the circular Planet Frame. Place it on the table — this defines the boundary of the playable surface. Note the connection points labeled along the edges (a, b, c, etc.) — hexes at opposite edges sharing the same letter are adjacent for movement and range (the planet wraps around).

Step 2 — Build the Planet

Shuffle all 61 Hex Tiles face-down. Place them randomly within the Planet Frame — tiles fill the entire interior of the circular board with no gaps. No peeking — the planet's geography is unknown until your forces make landfall.

Step 3 — Reveal the Surface

Flip all Hex Tiles face-up. The planet is revealed. Take a moment to survey the terrain — note where the resources, Spaceport Drop Zones, and Separatist Bases have appeared.

Step 4 — Place Number Tokens

Distribute the 15 Number Tokens across the 15 resource-producing Hexes (Oil Rigs, Power Plants, Factories, Radar Dishes, and Cities/Villages) — one token per hex. Separatist Bases and Spaceport Drop Zones already have their numbers printed on the tile and do not receive Number Tokens.

Number	Tokens Available	Placement
1	2	Place on 2 resource Hexes
2	2	Place on 2 resource Hexes
3	3	Place on 3 resource Hexes
4	3	Place on 3 resource Hexes
5	3	Place on 3 resource Hexes
6	2	Place on 2 resource Hexes

Place them randomly. Each resource-producing Hex receives exactly one Number Token. Edge numbers (1, 2, 6) are scarcer — only 2 hexes each — while middle numbers (3, 4, 5) appear on 3 hexes each, creating a natural production curve.

Step 5 — Prepare the BAC Cards

Sort the 100 BAC Cards into two decks:

- Spaceport Deck (75 cards): All 15 standard BAC types (5 copies each). This is the main deck used for starting hands and regular purchases.
- Advanced BAC Deck (25 cards): The 5 Level 2 BAC types (5 copies each) — 3 C.A.P armor upgrades plus L.P.M and P.A.E.H (cards that enhance other BACs). These require a prerequisite BAC type to be unlocked first.

Shuffle the Spaceport Deck face-down. Then:

1. Deal 3 BAC Cards face-down to each player from the Spaceport Deck. Players look at their cards but keep them secret.
2. Each player chooses 1 card to keep and passes the remaining 2 cards face-down to the player on their left.
3. From the 2 cards received, each player chooses 1 card to keep and passes the last card to the left.
4. Each player keeps the final card received. All players now have a starting hand of 3 BAC Cards.
5. Place the remaining Spaceport Deck near the board.
6. Turn 6 cards face-up in a row beside the Spaceport Deck — this is the Planet Bound Area.

Always maintain 6 face-up cards in the Planet Bound Area and 5 face-up cards in the Advanced BAC Area. Whenever a card is taken, immediately replace it from the corresponding deck.

Shuffle the Advanced BAC Deck (the remaining 20 cards) and place it beside the Planet Bound Area. Place one copy of each Advanced BAC type (C.A.P Chest, C.A.P Head, C.A.P Legs, L.P.M, P.A.E.H) face-up next to it — this is the Advanced BAC Area (5 cards). These cards are only available to players who have unlocked the corresponding prerequisite BAC type (see Equipping Rules).

Step 6 — Prepare the Conspire Deck

Shuffle all 72 Conspire Cards and place them face-down near the board as the Conspire Deck. Do not deal any Conspire Cards during setup — they are only acquired during play.

Step 7 — Muster Your Forces

Each player takes the following in their chosen color:

- 10 H.A.M.S Miniatures (organized into 2 Squads of 5 soldiers each, e.g. A1–A5 and B1–B5)
- A pool of damage pegs kept beside the play area

Additional H.A.M.S are recruited during the game. You may eventually command up to 4 Squads of 7 H.A.M.S each (28 total).

Step 8 — Determine First Player

The oldest player takes the first turn. Play order proceeds clockwise from the first player.

Step 9 — Squad Placement (Snake Draft)

Players deploy their starting Squads to the planet surface using a snake draft. H.A.M.S drop from orbit — landing zones must be clear of hostile forces and away from critical infrastructure to avoid casualties and collateral damage.

Order	Action
Round 1	Starting with the first player and proceeding clockwise, each player places their 1st Squad on any unoccupied Terrain Hex (not resource hexes, Spaceports, or Separatist Bases).
Round 2	The last player in Round 1 immediately places their 2nd Squad on any unoccupied Terrain Hex. Then placement continues counter-clockwise, ending with the first player placing their 2nd Squad last.

Place Control Flags: After placing each Squad, also place one of your Control Flags on the same hex. These hexes are your Landing Zones — they start under your control. Landing Zones give 0 Territory DP (see Claiming a Hex). Keep your remaining Control Flags near your two starting Squads so they're ready to place as you claim hexes during the game.

Step 10 — Set Up the Unloading Zone

Place one set of 6 numbered Cargo Containers (1–6) in a row near the board — this is the Unloading Zone. Keep the second matching set of containers nearby.

When BAC cards arrive at spaceports during the game (via doubles/triples):

1. Place the BAC card face-up in the Unloading Zone under the container matching that spaceport's printed number. If BACs already exist in that slot, stack them face-up under the same container.
2. Place the matching container from the second set on the corresponding spaceport hex on the board to mark the delivery (if not already there).

Collecting BACs: During a Logistics action, a Squad occupying a spaceport hex with a container marker may collect all BAC cards from the matching Unloading Zone slot into their hand. Remove the container from the board hex and reset the Unloading Zone slot.

Step 11 — Stock the Supply

Set up a resource supply area beside the board. Sort all Resource Tokens by type into clearly separated piles so any player can easily access them.

Note — Every Planet Is Different! The random Hex placement during setup ensures that no two games of W.A.R H.A.M.S are alike. The geography of your planet, the location of critical resources, and the proximity of Separatist threats will change every session. Adapt your strategy — or be crushed.

TURN STRUCTURE

Starting from the first player and proceeding clockwise, each player completes all four phases of their turn before play passes to the next player. No other player may act during your turn unless a Conspire Card or combat specifically requires it.

The shared Round Tracker begins at Round 1. Each player's tracker begins at TURN READY and 0 DP. Adjust your DP counter whenever a rule or card awards or removes DP. After completing Phase 4, mark your tracker TURN DONE.

Phase 1: Resource Production

The active player rolls 2d6 + 1 Separatist Die (a grey d6). All three dice produce resources normally — for each unique number rolled, place 1 corresponding resource token on every hex tile bearing that number token. Duplicate dice do not produce extra resources — rolling the same number twice still produces only once for that number. This includes hexes currently occupied by Separatist forces.

Example: You roll 2, 4, and the Separatist Die shows 6. Every hex with a "2", "4", or "6" number token receives 1 resource token of its type. Example (Doubles): You roll 3, 3, and the Separatist Die shows 5. Every hex with a "3" token receives 1 resource token (not 2 — duplicates don't double production), and every hex with a "5" token receives 1 resource token. The doubled 3s also trigger a BAC delivery (see Doubles below).

Separatist Base Result — After producing resources, resolve the grey Separatist Die using Phase 4: Separatists — Base Results. A matching unconquered base spawns Separatists; a matching conquered base instead gives 1 Local Favor directly to its controller. The player who rolled the die does not matter. Newly spawned forces remain at their base until Phase 4.

Doubles — If two of the three dice show the same number (e.g., 3, 3, 5):

- Take the BAC card from the Planet Bound Area whose position matches the doubled number (e.g., double 3s = the 3rd card in the row). Place it face-up in the Unloading Zone container slot matching that number, and place the matching numbered container on the spaceport hex with that printed number on the board. Multiple BAC cards may accumulate at a single Unloading Zone slot over successive turns.
- All unique numbers rolled still produce resources normally (the BAC delivery is an additional bonus, not a replacement).

Triples — If all three dice show the same number (e.g., 4, 4, 4):

- The active player chooses which spaceport drop zone on the board receives a BAC card. Take the BAC card from the Planet Bound Area whose position matches the tripled number (e.g., triple 4s = the 4th card). Place it face-up in the Unloading Zone container slot matching the chosen spaceport's printed number, and place the matching container on that spaceport hex.
- Additionally, the active player may move any single open (face-up) BAC from the Planet Bound Area to any Unloading Zone container slot of their choice.

Tip: Triples are rare but powerful — choosing which spaceport receives a BAC card lets you funnel valuable equipment toward your controlled zones or deny it to opponents.

Phase 2: Activation Phase

During the Activation Phase, the active player activates all of their Squads one by one. Each Squad takes 2 actions, resolving each action completely before taking its second action or activating the next Squad. After all of the active player's Squads have activated, play proceeds to Phase 3. Any action type may be chosen twice (for example, Move -> Move to move twice, or Conspire -> Conspire to draw twice).

Action: Move

The activating player may move each H.A.M.S in the activating Squad up to 1 hex in any direction. A soldier equipped with Jump Jets (J.J) may move up to 2 hexes instead.

Soldiers within a Squad move independently — they are not required to stay grouped. Spreading out allows a Squad to cover more hexes for resource gathering, but isolated soldiers are vulnerable to attack. However, every soldier must remain within 2 hexes of at least one other squadmate at all times (squad coherency).

Exception — Jump Jets (J.J): A soldier equipped with J.J may move beyond squad coherency range, explicitly overriding the 2-hex rule. While disconnected (beyond 2 hexes of all squadmates), the soldier fights alone — rolling only their own dice with no squad support. They cannot benefit from Squad-level BAC effects (e.g., S.L.I.M.E (Squad Light Interoperable Mortar Encampment) crew, L.P.M (Laser Pointer Marker) spotting). The soldier may rejoin their Squad by moving back within 2 hexes of a squadmate on a later Move action.

Example: A 5-soldier Squad on hex A could split: 2 soldiers stay on hex A, 1 moves to hex B, and 2 move to hex C. All five remain part of the same Squad — A is 2 hexes away from C, maintaining coherency.

Moving Through Separatists — A soldier may not move through a hex occupied by Separatist forces without engaging them in combat first (see Action: Combat).

Board Wrapping — The planet is round. Hexes at the edges of the board connect to corresponding hexes on the opposite edge via marked connection points (labeled a, b, c, etc.). Movement and range calculations wrap accordingly.

Claim Hexes (after each Move action)

Immediately after the Move action, for every hex containing one or more of the activating Squad's soldiers and no enemy soldiers, place one of your Control Flags on that hex. If an opposing flag is already there, return it to that opponent's supply and replace it with yours. If your own flag is already there, leave it. Flags on hexes you do not currently occupy remain in place until an opponent later claims them by this same rule — the planet stays painted in your colour even after your Squad moves on.

Hexes containing both your soldiers AND an enemy's are contested — no flag is placed or changed. Wait until a Combat action resolves who occupies the hex; Claim Hexes after that Combat action will then settle the flag.

Action: Combat

Combat is optional. A Squad with an enemy unit — whether belonging to another player or Separatist forces — within the combat range of at least one active soldier may declare one combat. Only soldiers with an enemy in their combat range are engaged and participate. Separatist combats triggered during Phase 4 are mandatory (see Phase 4: Separatists — Combat Rules).

To declare combat:

1. The active player states which of their Squads is attacking.
2. The active player designates which enemy Squad (or Separatist group) is the target.
3. Place a Combat Marker at that combat's board location.
4. Before moving any miniatures, note each engaged soldier's original hex. Place the attacker's engaged H.A.M.S in positions 1–7 on the South Combat Board and the defender's engaged H.A.M.S in positions 1–7 on the North Combat Board. Put each assigned combat die in front of its soldier in the matching numbered die position.
5. Resolve combat according to the full Combat section below. Then return surviving H.A.M.S to their original hexes and return the marker to its staging area.

Combat Boards are staging aids only. Moving a miniature to a Combat Board does not change its board position, range, control, or coherency. Resolve deaths, retreats, advances, and salvage using the soldier's original hex; place any dropped salvage there.

Multiple Combats — If the active player has multiple Squads engaged with different enemy forces, each may declare a separate Combat action. Resolve combats one at a time, in the order chosen by the active player. The two markers can identify the next two declared locations; reuse a returned marker if more combats remain.

Note: Only the active player may initiate a Combat action. Defending players respond as part of combat resolution but do not initiate attacks of their own.

Claim Hexes (after each Combat action)

Immediately after the Combat action is resolved, for every hex containing one or more of the activating Squad's soldiers and no enemy soldiers, place your Control Flag (return any opposing flag to its owner's supply). This catches hexes that combat just cleared — for example, a hex you successfully attacked and pushed the defender off, or a contested hex where your soldiers survived and the opponent's didn't.

If a base was conquered during this action (all 7 base defenders killed), the conquering player places their flag on the base hex as part of this step.

Action: Logistics

During a Logistics action, the active player may unlock and equip BAC types, acquire new BAC cards, recruit soldiers, create new Squads, activate field modules, recharge tapped modules, and trade. All Logistics actions may be performed in any order and any number of times during a single Logistics action, resources permitting.

Equipping a BAC:

There are two ways to equip a BAC — unlocking a new type, or re-equipping a type you've already unlocked.

Unlocking a new BAC type:

1. Choose a BAC card from your hand and place it face-up in the Equipment Display (shared reference area near the board). If the card is already in the Display, discard your copy instead.
2. Place one of your Control Flags on that card in the Equipment Display — this marks that you have permanently unlocked this BAC type.
3. The first soldier is equipped for free as part of unlocking. Pay the card's resource cost for each additional soldier you wish to equip.
4. Attach the matching equipment module (magnetized part) to each equipped soldier's miniature in the correct slot (Head, Chest, Legs, Backpack, or Hands).
5. Add the card's DP value to your DP counter for each soldier equipped (check the DP value printed on the BAC card).

Equipping has no location requirement — you may equip any of your soldiers regardless of where they are on the board. Soldiers recruited this action may also be equipped immediately.

Re-equipping an unlocked BAC type:

If your Control Flag is already on a BAC card in the Equipment Display, you may equip additional soldiers with that type during a Logistics action — no card needed, just pay the resource cost per soldier, attach the module, and add the card's DP value to your DP counter for each soldier equipped.

Limit: Only 8 copies of each equipment module exist in the game. If all 8 are currently in use, no more soldiers can equip that type until a module is freed (destroyed modules return to the box and can be purchased again).

Example: You have an H.C.A.R (Heavy Caliber Assault Rifle) card in hand. You place it in the Equipment Display and put your red flag on it — H.C.A.R is now unlocked for you permanently. The first soldier is equipped for free. You pay 1 Industry + 1 Oil for each additional soldier and snap H.C.A.R rifle modules onto their Hands slot. Next turn, you recruit a new soldier and want to arm them too — just pay 1 Industry + 1 Oil again, no card needed.

Acquiring New BACs:

- Spaceport Deck Purchase: Spend 3 resource tokens of any single type while your Squad is at or adjacent to a Spaceport or City -> draw 1 face-down card from the Spaceport Deck into your hand.
- Advanced BAC Deck Purchase: If you have unlocked the corresponding prerequisite BAC type, you may spend 3 resource tokens of any single type while your Squad is at or adjacent to a Spaceport or City -> take 1 face-up card from the Advanced BAC Area into your hand. You may only take an Advanced BAC card whose prerequisite you have unlocked. When a card is taken, immediately refill that slot from the top of the Advanced BAC Deck. Prerequisites: C.A.P Chest -> S.A.P Chest, C.A.P Head -> S.A.P Helmet, C.A.P Legs -> S.A.P Legs, L.P.M -> B.A.S.R or S.L.I.M.E, P.A.E.H -> H.C.A.R.
- Spaceport Drop Zone Collection: If a Squad occupies a spaceport hex with a container marker, collect all BAC cards from the matching Unloading Zone slot into your hand. Remove the container from the board hex and reset the slot.

Recruiting New Soldiers:

Pay 1 Local Favor + 1 Oil + 1 Industry + 1 Electricity while your Squad is in or adjacent to a City -> add 1 H.A.M.S to that Squad.

- Maximum 7 soldiers per Squad.

Creating New Squads:

Pay the soldier recruitment cost × the number of soldiers in the new Squad (minimum 5 soldiers to form a Squad).

- Maximum 4 Squads per player.
- The new Squad is placed at the City where it was recruited.

Example: Creating a new 5-soldier Squad costs 5 × (1 Local Favor + 1 Oil + 1 Industry + 1 Electricity) = 5 Local Favor + 5 Oil + 5 Industry + 5 Electricity.

Trading:

The active player may trade resource tokens freely with any other player. Both parties must agree to the terms of the trade. There is no limit to the number of trades per turn.

- Only resource tokens may be traded. BAC cards, Conspire Cards, and equipment cannot be traded.
- All trades must be two-sided — both players must give and receive at least 1 resource token. No gifting or taking resources for free.
- Trades must be executed immediately — no promises of future payment or deferred trades are enforceable.
- Bank Trade: You may trade with the supply at a 3:1 ratio — return 3 of any single resource type to the supply and take 1 of any other type. No limit on bank trades per turn.

Example: Trading 1 Oil for 1 Electricity with another player is valid. Giving 1 Oil for nothing in return is not. If no one will trade, you can return 3 Oil to the supply and take 1 Electricity from the bank.

Action: Conspire

Spend one of the activating Squad's actions to draw 3 cards from the Conspire Deck, keep 1, and discard the other 2 face-down to the Conspire discard pile. If a drawn card states otherwise (for example, "keep 2"), follow that card's instructions. See the full Conspiring section for hand limits, card timing, and deck exhaustion.

A Squad may Conspire twice by spending both of its actions, drawing twice.

Action: Rest

Roll 1d3: roll 1d6 and divide the result by 2, rounding up (1–2 = 1, 3–4 = 2, 5–6 = 3). Remove that many damage pegs total from soldiers in the activating Squad. The player chooses which soldiers to heal and how to distribute the removed pegs.

Damage persists between turns. Rest is the basic way to recover without using cards.

Phase 3: Salvage & Resource Gathering

After all Squad activations are complete, only the active player resolves salvage and resource gathering for their Squads.

Step 1 — Salvage Collection (if any):

Before collecting resources, the active player's soldiers may pick up salvage modules on the hexes they occupy (left behind after a death — see Death in W.A.R H.A.M.S, Step 4). Salvaged modules can be equipped for free — simply attach the module to the soldier's miniature.

Step 2 — Resource Collection:

- For every distinct resource-producing hex occupied by at least one soldier from one of your Squads, collect 1 resource token from that hex, if available.
- Each hex provides resources only once per turn, regardless of how many of your soldiers or Squads occupy it.
- If a soldier occupying that hex has B.E.A.R (Battlefield Extraction Airlift Rover), you may collect 1 additional resource token from the same hex. Multiple B.E.A.R modules on one hex do not stack.

Important: Resources cannot be collected from a hex occupied by Separatist units. Defeat them first.

Collected resource tokens go directly into the player's personal supply.

Phase 4: Separatists

Separatists are rogue fighting forces loyal to no corporation — remnants of failed colonial garrisons, opportunistic raiders, and alien sympathizers who resist all outside control. This phase contains all rules for their components, spawning, behavior, combat, and bases.

Components & Bases

- The game has 24 grey Separatist miniatures, shared by roaming forces, base defenders, and militia.
- The three Separatist Bases have 2, 4, and 6 printed on their tiles. They never receive Number Tokens.
- Whenever a rule would spawn more Separatists than remain in the supply, spawn as many as possible. Any excess spawn is lost.

Separatist Base Results (Phase 1)

During Phase 1, compare the grey Separatist Die with the printed number on each Separatist Base:

- Unconquered matching base: Spawn 3 Separatists on that base.
- Conquered matching base: Its controlling player immediately gains 1 Local Favor from the supply instead. This happens regardless of which player rolled the die and does not require all three bases to be conquered.

The other two resource dice never trigger either result.

Spawned Separatists remain on the base. Do not consume resources, move them, or resolve their combat until Phase 4. A conquered base no longer spawns naturally.

Phase 4 Procedure

The active player resolves all four steps below for every Separatist on the board, regardless of territory. This includes Separatists spawned during the current turn's Phase 1 and those spawned by Instigate Uprising.

Step 1 — Instigate Uprising

Each player who controls a conquered Separatist Base may pay 3 Local Favor to spawn 3 Separatists at any one unconquered base. This ability may be used once per round per conquered base that player controls. Spawned forces stay at the target base until Step 3.

Step 2 — Consume

Remove 1 token from every hex containing one or more Separatists and one or more resource tokens. Consumption is once per occupied hex, not once per Separatist — a hex with 3 Separatists still loses only 1 token. Return removed tokens to the supply and resolve all consumption simultaneously.

Step 3 — Move

Resolve Separatists one at a time. Each may move up to 3 hexes, following this priority:

1. Look within 3 hexes for any resource-producing hex (Oil Rig, Power Plant, Factory, Radar Dish, or City/Village) containing at least 1 resource token.
2. If one or more qualify, choose the hex containing the most resource tokens. The active player breaks ties.
3. If none qualify, choose the nearest resource-producing hex, even if it is empty. The active player breaks ties. Move up to 3 hexes toward it; continue on a later turn if it is farther away.

BAC cards and cargo containers are not resources and are never movement targets. A Spaceport Drop Zone does not attract Separatists merely because it contains a cargo container or BAC delivery.

A Separatist already on its chosen target moves 0 hexes. Each adjacent step counts as 1 hex. Separatists move directly to the chosen hex regardless of any friendly or enemy forces in the way — they do not stop for, engage, or interact with units on intervening hexes. Interception and combat only happen on the destination hex (resolved in Step 4). Finish moving every Separatist before beginning Step 4.

The locals know every cave, tunnel, and goat-path across this world. They slip past armies and through front lines without pause — only the hex they're heading to matters.

Tip: A producing hex with many tokens attracts every Separatist that selects it under this priority. Clearing valuable piles near your forces can redirect the swarm.

Step 4 — Resolve Combats

Resolve mandatory combat on every hex shared by Separatists and player soldiers. The defending player fights normally; the player to the defender's left rolls the Separatist dice. Resolve contested hexes clockwise, starting from the active player.

Combat Rules

Rule	Detail
Rolled By	The player to the left of the player fighting the Separatists rolls every Separatist die
Separatist Penalty	All Separatists (roaming and base defenders) apply -1 to defense dice only, to a minimum result of 1. Attack dice are unmodified
Hit Points	Each Separatist has 1 life; any hit kills it immediately
Player Attacks	A player may voluntarily attack a Separatist group during a Combat action under the normal engagement rules
Mandatory Combat	Combat is mandatory after Separatists enter a player's hex during Phase 4
Blocking	A player must defeat Separatists before moving through their hex or collecting resources there

Conquering Bases

- The first attack against an unconquered base triggers 7 base defenders. They are dug in but apply the Separatist defense penalty like all Separatists.
- Defeat all 7 defenders to conquer the base, then place your Control Flag on its hex.
- Surviving defenders become roaming Separatists and follow the Phase 4 procedure.
- Conquered bases stop spawning naturally (their printed number no longer triggers spawns).
- The controller gains the Instigate Uprising ability described in Step 1.
- Whenever the Separatist Die matches a conquered base's printed number, that base's controller immediately gains 1 Local Favor, regardless of who rolled the die.

Warning: Don't attack a base unless you can handle all 7 defenders! Survivors scatter toward resource hexes.

End of Turn

Once all four phases are complete, play passes clockwise to the next player, who begins their turn at Phase 1.

End of Round

A round is one full cycle of all players' turns (each player completes Phases 1–4 once). After the last player in turn order finishes their turn, resolve the following before the next round begins:

- Any uncollected resource tokens remaining on hexes you control (marked with your Control Flag) are added to your personal supply.
- Any spaceport hexes you control that have a container marker on them: collect all BAC cards from the matching Unloading Zone slot into your hand. Remove the container from the board hex and reset the slot.

Advance the Round Tracker by 1 and reset every player tracker to TURN READY. Then a new round begins with the first player.

Turn Summary — Quick Reference

Phase	Name	Summary
1	Resource Production	Roll 3d6, spawn resources on matching hexes. Doubles/triples = BAC drops at spaceports
2	Activation Phase	Each Squad takes 2 actions: Move, Combat, Logistics, Conspire, or Rest. Any may be repeated
3	Salvage & Resource Gathering	Collect salvage, then 1 token from each distinct resource hex occupied by your Squads; B.E.A.R grants +1 on its hex
4	Separatists	Uprising -> consume -> move -> combat

COMBAT SYSTEM

Steel meets steel. Dice hit the table. Only one side walks away whole.

Combat is the heart of W.A.R H.A.M.S. When corporations clash over hexes, resources, and dominance, the battlefield is decided through a structured sequence of dice rolls, tactical assignments, equipment bonuses, and card play.

Initiating Combat

During a Combat action in the Activation Phase, they may declare an attack with any of their Squads against an enemy Squad (or Separatist group). This is separate from mandatory Separatist combat during Phase 4 (see Phase 4: Separatists — Combat Rules).

Starting Range — Empty Hands: A H.A.M.S with no weapon equipped in its Hands slot has a combat range of 1 hex: it can fight enemies on the same hex or an adjacent hex. It attacks and defends normally and rolls 1d6. Equipping a Hands-slot weapon does not increase range beyond 1 hex unless that weapon explicitly states a longer range (e.g., B.A.S.R, S.L.I.M.E). Equipment in other slots does not increase the empty-Hands range.

- Each Squad may declare one Combat action per turn.
- To initiate combat, at least one soldier in the attacking Squad must have at least one soldier in the target Squad within their combat range.
- Engaged soldiers only: A soldier participates and rolls dice only when at least one enemy soldier in the target Squad is within that soldier's combat range. Soldiers without an enemy in range sit out — they do not roll attack or defense dice.
- S.L.I.M.E (mortar) has extended range and may fire from beyond 1 hex (up to 3 hexes). Mortar crew count as engaged even if outside normal range. B.A.S.R (Bolt Action Sniper Rifle) fires at up to 2 hexes in a pre-combat step — within normal engagement range, but its range can be extended via L.P.M (Laser Pointer Module) (up to 4 hexes). See Special Weapon Rules below.
- Only the active player may initiate combat. Defenders respond during combat resolution but do not choose to attack on another player's turn.

Combat Resolution — Step by Step

Once combat is declared, resolve it by following Step 0 and then Steps 1 through 8 in order.

Step 0: Pre-Combat

Before any attack or defense dice are rolled, resolve all pre-combat effects in the following order:

0a — Reveal Phase (S.H.A.D):

If the defender has a soldier equipped with S.H.A.D (Sensory Helmet, Advisory Drone), the attacker must immediately reveal all of their Conspire Cards in hand to the defender. The defender may look at them but does not take them. This happens before any pre-combat attacks or cards are played.

0b — Pre-Combat Cards:

Both players may play Tactical Conspire Cards that affect the upcoming combat (e.g., A Rough Night to immobilize and penalize a Squad). The defender plays first, then the attacker responds. Each player may play any number of eligible cards. Resolve each card's effect immediately before the next card is played.

0c — Pre-Combat Attacks (B.A.S.R & S.L.I.M.E):

The attacker resolves any pre-combat weapon attacks:

- B.A.S.R (Sniper): Roll 2d6, pick the higher result. Target 1 specific defending soldier up to 2 hexes away (up to 4 hexes with L.P.M). The target defends normally (1d6). If the attack hits, apply damage immediately — this may kill the target before normal combat. The sniper does not participate in normal combat (Steps 1–8).
- S.L.I.M.E (Mortar): Roll 4d6 and assign as matchups against the entire defending Squad up to 3 hexes away (up to 4 hexes with L.P.M). All defenders suffer -1 to all defense dice. Resolve damage immediately. Mortar crew skip normal combat. If the target hex is a City/Village, the Civilian Damage Rule applies.

Simultaneous effects: If both players have pre-combat attacks (e.g., both have a B.A.S.R), resolve the attacker's pre-combat attacks first, then the defender's. Within a single side, resolve B.A.S.R before S.L.I.M.E.

Important: Soldiers killed during Step 0 are removed immediately and do not participate in Steps 1–8. Their dice are not rolled. If the defending Squad is completely eliminated in Step 0, combat ends — proceed directly to Step 7 (Defender Withdrawal — no one left to withdraw) and Step 8 (Battle Victory DP).

Step 1: Roll Attack & Defense Dice

Both players roll simultaneously.

- Attacker rolls 1d6 for each engaged H.A.M.S in the attacking Squad, using each soldier's current combat range.
- Defender rolls 1d6 for each engaged H.A.M.S in the defending Squad.

Dice Advantage Rule

When one side has more soldiers than the other, the side with more soldiers still rolls dice equal to their full soldier count. However, only a number of dice equal to the smaller Squad's size are used in matchups. The player with more dice selects their best dice (highest values) to assign.

The extra dice provide more options — not more attacks or defenses. The number of matchups is always equal to the smaller Squad's soldier count.

Worked Example — Attacker Outnumbers Defender: A 5-soldier Squad attacks a 3-soldier Squad. - Attacker rolls 5 dice: 1, 1, 5, 5, 6 - Defender rolls 3 dice: 4, 4, 2 - The smaller Squad has 3 soldiers, so there are 3 matchups. - Attacker picks their best 3 dice: 5, 5, 6 - Defender must use all 3 of their dice: 4, 4, 2 - Attacker assigns matchups: 6->4, 5->4, 5->2 — all three defenders are hit!

Worked Example — Defender Outnumbers Attacker: A 3-soldier Squad attacks a 5-soldier Squad. - Attacker rolls 3 dice: 5, 5, 6 - Defender rolls 5 dice: 1, 1, 4, 4, 2 - There are 3 matchups (equal to the smaller Squad). - Attacker must use all 3 of their dice: 5, 5, 6 - Defender picks their best 3 from 5 dice: 4, 4, 2 - Matchups: 6->4, 5->4, 5->2 — still hits, but the defender had more choices to select their strongest defense dice.

Step 2: Assign Dice (Attacker Chooses Matchups)

After both sides have selected their dice, the Attacker assigns matchups. This is one of the most tactically important moments in combat.

1. The Attacker places each of their selected attack dice in front of a specific defending H.A.M.S miniature. Each defending soldier receives exactly one attack die.
2. The Defender then assigns their defense dice, placing one defense die next to each attack die.

Each matchup is now a one-on-one comparison:

Comparison	Result
Attack die > Defense die	HIT — the difference equals damage dealt
Attack die <= Defense die	BLOCKED — no damage is dealt

Worked Example — Dice Assignment: Attacker rolls: 6, 4, 1 — Defender rolls: 5, 4, 6 The Attacker assigns:

Target	Attack Die	Defense Die	Result
Soldier A	6	5	HIT (6 - 5 = 1 damage)
Soldier B	4	4	BLOCKED (tie goes to defender)
Soldier C	1	6	BLOCKED (defense wins)

Total: 1 hit dealing 1 damage peg to Soldier A. Note: The Attacker chose to throw their 6 at Soldier A. A different assignment would have changed the outcome entirely. Choose your matchups wisely.

Step 3: Apply Equipment Bonuses

After initial dice placement, both sides apply bonuses from equipped BAC cards. Bonuses modify the face value of dice already placed — they do not add additional dice.

1. Attacker applies attack bonuses first (e.g., H.C.A.R grants +1 attack to the equipped soldier's die).
2. Defender applies defense bonuses second (e.g., S.A.P armor grants +1 defense to the equipped soldier's die).

Equipment bonuses can change the outcome of matchups that were previously hits or blocks.

Worked Example — Equipment Bonuses: From the previous example, Soldier A was hit: Attack 6 vs Defense 5 = 1 damage. But Soldier A is equipped with S.A.P armor (+1 defense). The defense die increases from 5 to 6.

Target	Attack Die	Defense Die (after bonus)	Result
Soldier A	6	5 + 1 = 6	BLOCKED! S.A.P armor saves Soldier A.

Conversely: if the Attacker had a H.C.A.R.-equipped soldier (+1 attack), the attack die would have been 7 vs 6 — a hit for 1 damage, punching through the armor.

Step 4: Play Conspire Cards

After equipment bonuses are applied, both players may play Combat Conspire Cards (Guerrilla Warfare, Defender Instant Shield, Old School RPG, One Pulse Barrier) to alter the outcome.

Order of play:

1. Defender plays Combat Conspire Cards first.
2. Attacker responds with their own Combat Conspire Cards second.

Each player may play any number of eligible Combat Conspire Cards. Tactical Conspire Cards cannot be played during this step.

Example Conspire Card	Effect
Guerrilla Warfare	Add 1d6 to your attack total
Defender Instant Shield	Add 1d6 to your defense total
Old School RPG	Grant +1 attack to one soldier's die
One Pulse Barrier	Grant +1 defense to one soldier's die

Tip: The Defender plays first — the Attacker always gets the last word. A shrewd Attacker can wait to see the Defender's cards before deciding whether to spend their own.

Step 5: Resolve Damage

After all dice modifications and card effects are applied, calculate final damage for every matchup.

For each HIT (attack die > defense die):

- The difference between the final attack value and the final defense value equals the number of damage pegs inserted into the divots on that defending H.A.M.S's base.
- Each base has 3 blood-drop divots. Insert one red peg per point of damage taken.
- Damage persists between turns. A wounded H.A.M.S keeps its pegs until healed by a card effect or ability (which removes pegs from the divots).

Combat Winner

The player who inflicted more total damage across all matchups in this combat is the combat winner.

Death Threshold

A H.A.M.S can sustain a maximum of 3 damage pegs. When a soldier would receive a 4th damage peg, that soldier dies.

Worked Example: Soldier A already carries 2 damage pegs from a previous turn. In this combat, Soldier A's matchup results in a HIT dealing 2 damage. Soldier A now has 2 + 2 = 4 damage pegs -> Soldier A is killed.

Step 6: Counterattack

After all damage is resolved, check every defender's matchup for a potential Counterattack.

Counterattack Trigger: Any defending soldier whose defense die beat the attack die by 2 or more earns a Counterattack.

Defender	Attack Die	Defense Die	Difference	Result
Soldier A	6	5	-1 (attacker won)	No counterattack
Soldier B	4	4	+0 for defender	No counterattack (difference < 2)
Soldier C	1	6	+5 for defender	COUNTERATTACK triggered

When a Counterattack is triggered:

1. The counterattacking defender becomes the Attacker in a new mini-combat round.
2. All normal combat rules apply (Steps 1–6), using only the counterattacking soldier(s) and the original attacker's soldiers they were matched against.
3. Counterattacks can chain - a counterattacker who wins by 2+ triggers another counterattack. Chains continue naturally until a roll fails to trigger another counter (defense does not beat attack by 2+).

Worked Example — Counterattack: Continuing from the earlier combat: The Attacker assigned a 1 against Soldier C's defense of 6. Difference: 6 - 1 = 5 (>= 2) — Counterattack triggered! Mini-Combat Round (Chain 1): Soldier C is now the Attacker. Both sides roll 1d6:

Matchup	Attack Die	Defense Die	Result
Soldier C vs Original Attacker	2	5	BLOCKED (defense wins by 3)

The original attacker's defense die (5) beat the attack die (2) by 3 — above the threshold of 2. Another Counterattack triggers! Mini-Combat Round (Chain 2): The original attacker strikes back. Both roll 1d6 with no penalty:

Matchup	Attack Die	Defense Die	Result
Original Attacker vs Soldier C	4	3	HIT (1 damage)

Difference is only 1 — no further counterattack. The chain ends.

Step 7: Defender Withdrawal

After all counterattacks are resolved and damage is applied, the defender may choose to withdraw any or all of their surviving engaged soldiers. Each withdrawing soldier moves 1 hex away from the attacker's position, following normal movement rules (squad coherency, board wrapping, cannot move through Separatist-occupied hexes).

- Withdrawal is free and does not cost an action.
- The defender chooses which soldiers withdraw and which stay.
- A soldier with no valid hex to withdraw to (surrounded, edge-locked, or blocked by Separatists) stays put.
- Only the defender may withdraw. The attacker does not advance.

Step 8: Battle Victory DP

After withdrawal, compare total wounds inflicted by each side (damage pegs placed on enemy soldiers, including kills). The side that inflicted more wounds than they received earns Battle Victory DP equal to the difference, up to a maximum of 3 DP.

- If both sides inflicted the same number of wounds, neither side earns DP.
- Both attacker and defender are eligible — winning a defense earns DP too.
- Add the DP to your DP counter immediately. Battle Victory DP counts toward Victory 3: Dominance and does not go away if soldiers are later lost.

Tip: Withdrawal lets you break contact after a bad exchange, but it cedes the hex to the attacker for claiming.

Death in W.A.R H.A.M.S

When a H.A.M.S accumulates 4 or more damage pegs, the soldier is killed. Resolve immediately:

1. Lethal Hit Roll

The owning player rolls 1d6 to determine where the killing blow struck:

Roll	Slot Hit
1	Head
2	Backpack
3	Legs
4–5	Chest
6	Hands (weapon)

2. Module Destroyed

Detach the equipment module from the struck slot and return it to the box (it becomes available for purchase again). If the struck slot is empty (no module equipped), no module is destroyed — proceed directly to salvage distribution.

3. Salvage Distribution

Pick Order	Player	Action
1st	Owner (dead soldier's player)	Choose 1 remaining equipped module to keep — may immediately attach it to another existing soldier in the same Squad for free, provided that soldier is not outside of coherency
2nd	Attacker (killing player)	Choose 1 remaining equipped module to take — may immediately attach it to one of their soldiers for free, provided that soldier is not outside of coherency
3rd	—	All remaining modules are left on the hex as salvage

4. Salvage

Modules left on the hex may be picked up by any soldier occupying that hex during Phase 3: Salvage & Resource Gathering, Step 1 (Salvage Collection). Salvage collection happens before regular resource gathering. Salvaged modules can be equipped for free (the cost was already paid) — simply attach the module to the soldier's mini. Check the Equipment Display to confirm the module's identity and effect.

5. Coherency Check

After a death, check if any surviving squadmates are now beyond 2 hexes from all other squadmates. If so, those soldiers are disconnected — they fight alone (own dice only, no Squad-level BAC effects), identical to the J.J disconnection rules. Disconnected soldiers suffer a -1 penalty to all dice rolls (minimum 1) and must use their next Move action to move back within 2 hexes of a squadmate. Until they rejoin, they cannot benefit from effects like S.L.I.M.E crew, L.P.M spotting, or other Squad-level abilities.

Civilian Damage Rule

When using area-of-effect weaponry — specifically S.L.I.M.E (mortar) or other artillery — on a hex that produces Local Favor (City or Village):

- All opposing players each gain 2 Local Favor resource tokens immediately.
- The attacking player loses ALL of their current Local Favor tokens.

Bombarding cities wins battles but loses hearts and minds.

Separatist Combat

Separatist battles use the normal combat sequence with the exceptions listed in Phase 4: Separatists — Combat Rules, which is authoritative for who rolls their dice, penalties, hit points, mandatory combats, and base defenders.

Special Weapon Rules

B.A.S.R (Bolt Action Sniper Rifle) — Sniper Rifle

One shot. One kill. Before anyone else fires.	
Property	Value
Timing	Fires before normal combat (pre-combat step)
Dice	Roll 2d6, pick the higher result
Target	1 specific soldier up to 2 hexes away. Target defends normally (1d6)
Restriction	Sniper does not participate in normal combat
Vulnerability	While defending: both the sniper and the target get -1 to defense die

S.L.I.M.E (Squad Light Interoperable Mortar Encampment) — Mortar

Rain fire from a distance.	
Property	Value
Crew	Requires 2 soldiers
Dice	Roll 4d6
Target	An entire enemy Squad up to 3 hexes away
Restriction	Mortar crew skips normal combat
Vulnerability	-1 defense when attacked directly
Civilian Damage	Targeting a City/Village hex triggers the Civilian Damage Rule: all opposing players gain 2 Local Favor; attacker loses all Local Favor (see §Civilian Damage Rule)

L.P.M (Laser Pointer Marker) — Laser Pointer Module

Paint the target. Let the heavy weapons do the rest.	
Property	Value
Function	Extends B.A.S.R and S.L.I.M.E effective range
Mechanic	Weapons may target enemies adjacent to the L.P.M carrier
Maximum Range	4 hexes total
Restriction	L.P.M carrier does not fire — they designate targets

Bunker Rules

Bunker tokens are placed by the D.U.D.S (Deployable Unital Defense System) equipment module. Once deployed, a bunker becomes a permanent terrain feature on the hex.

Rule	Detail
Placement	Activate D.U.D.S to place a bunker token on the hex the soldier occupies. D.U.D.S module is removed from the soldier (one-use), freeing the backpack slot
Effect	+1 to all defense dice for any unit defending on this hex
Ownership	Bunkers are neutral fortifications — any unit on the hex benefits, regardless of faction
Stacking	1 bunker per hex maximum
Persistence	Bunker tokens remain on the hex until destroyed
Destruction	An attacker who wins combat on a bunkered hex may choose to destroy the bunker (remove the token) instead of claiming the hex
Bunker DP	Deployer earns 2 DP permanently upon deployment. Whoever controls the bunkered hex earns an additional 2 DP (total 4 DP for deployer holding their own bunker)

Tip: Bunkers alter the terrain permanently — place them on chokepoints you plan to hold, but beware: if you lose the hex, your enemies dig in behind your own fortifications.

Combat Quick Reference

Step	Action	Who Acts
Step 0	Pre-Combat: S.H.A.D reveal, pre-combat cards, B.A.S.R & S.L.I.M.E attacks	Both
Step 1	Roll attack & defense dice (1d6 per soldier)	Both
Step 2	Attacker assigns matchups; Defender assigns defense dice	Both
Step 3	Apply equipment bonuses (+attack, +defense)	Both
Step 4	Play Conspire Cards (Defender first, then Attacker)	Both
Step 5	Resolve damage (attack - defense = damage pegs)	—
Step 6	Check for Counterattacks (defense beat attack by 2+)	Defender
Step 7	Defender may withdraw surviving soldiers 1 hex (free)	Defender
Step 8	Award Battle Victory DP (wounds difference, max 3)	—

Key Thresholds:

Threshold	Value
Damage pegs to kill a H.A.M.S	4 (dies on the 4th peg)
Counterattack trigger	Defense beats attack by 2 or more (chains naturally until a roll fails to trigger)
Separatist lives	1 (dies on any hit)
Separatist dice penalty	-1 to defense dice only (all Separatists, including base defenders; min result 1)

Combat FAQ — Multi-Hex Attacks

Can one Squad attack while its soldiers occupy multiple hexes?

Yes. A Squad may be spread across several hexes (within coherency). When it declares a Combat action, every soldier who has at least one enemy in their combat range is engaged and participates, regardless of which hex they occupy. Soldiers on hexes with no enemy in range sit out.

Can a Squad concentrated on one hex attack an enemy Squad split across multiple hexes?

Yes. Combat targets the enemy Squad, not a single hex. The attacker engages every defending soldier who is within combat range of at least one attacking soldier. A defender on a distant hex with no attacker in range does not participate.

Do all engaged soldiers resolve one combat together?

Yes. All engaged soldiers on both sides roll dice and are assigned matchups in a single combat resolution. There is no per-hex splitting of dice or matchups — it is one fight.

Can multiple friendly Squads combine into one attack?

No. Each Squad declares and resolves its own Combat action separately. A Squad may only attack once per turn (using one of its 2 actions). Two Squads on the same hex or adjacent hexes cannot merge their dice into a single combat.

Does squad coherency still apply during multi-hex combat?

Yes. Coherency is checked at all times. If a death during combat leaves surviving soldiers beyond 2 hexes from all squadmates, they become disconnected (see Death, Step 5).

BASIC ARMAMENT CARDS (BACs)

BACs are the weapons, armor, gadgets, and tactical systems that transform your H.A.M.S from expendable grunts into an unstoppable force.

Card Anatomy

Zone	Location	Description
Name	Top center	The BAC's full military acronym designation
Cost	Top right	Resource cost per soldier equipped
Slot	Bottom left	Equipment slot: Head, Backpack, Legs, Chest, or Hands
DP Value	Bottom right	Dominance Points this card contributes while equipped
Card Text	Center	The BAC's mechanical effect

Equipment Slots

Each soldier has 5 equipment slots, determined by die roll when a slot is targeted:

Die Roll	Slot
1	Head
2	Backpack
3	Legs
4-5	Chest
6	Hands

Each soldier may carry 1 module per slot. A Squad may equip multiple BAC types, but no individual soldier may double up on a single slot.

Module Identification & the Equipment Display

Every equipment module has a unique sculpt — an H.C.A.R rifle looks different from a B.A.S.R sniper, a S.A.P Helmet looks different from a S.H.A.D (Sensory Helmet, Advisory Drone) helmet. Each module also has its abbreviation engraved on the underside for confirmation.

When a BAC type is equipped for the first time in the game, place its BAC card face-up in the Equipment Display — a shared area near the board visible to all players. Place one reference module on top of the card so everyone can see what that module looks like.

The Equipment Display serves as the communal reference for all active equipment in the game:

What you need to know	Where to look
What does this module do?	Equipment Display — read the BAC card
What is this module's DP value?	Equipment Display — check the card
Which soldiers have this module?	Look at the minis — the sculpt matches the reference module
Who owns which modules?	The modules physically attached to each player's colored minis

The modules on the minis are the source of truth — not cards, not boards. If a module is on your soldier, you have it. If it's not, you don't.

Tip: Any player can pick up a module from the board and compare its sculpt to the reference modules in the Equipment Display to identify it.

Equipping Rules

- Choose a BAC card from your hand. If this BAC type is not yet in the Equipment Display, place the card face-up there and place one of your Control Flags on it to mark it as permanently unlocked — the first soldier is equipped for free as part of unlocking. If it's already in the Equipment Display, discard the card and place your flag on the existing card.
- Pay the listed resource cost for each additional soldier you wish to equip.
- Attach the matching equipment module (physical magnetized part) to each equipped soldier's miniature in the correct slot.
- Modules = Truth: The physical modules on minis are the definitive record of who has what. The Equipment Display is for reference only.
- Flags are permanent: Once your Control Flag is placed on a BAC card in the Equipment Display, it stays for the rest of the game — even if all your soldiers carrying that module die. Your flag marks that you've unlocked that BAC type and can pay to equip it again.
- Exception — T.I.L.T.S (Tactical Ion Team Link Shield): Pay the listed cost per soldier as normal. During combat, two adjacent T.I.L.T.S soldiers may swap one attacker's assigned die between them. This ability is always active — no tapping required. No other backpack module may be equipped alongside T.I.L.T.S.
- Advanced BACs (Level 2): Five BAC types are Level 2 — only available from the Advanced BAC Area, never in the Spaceport Deck or starting hands. You may only acquire one if you have already unlocked its prerequisite (your Control Flag is on the prerequisite BAC card in the Equipment Display). Spend 3 resource tokens of any single type at a Spaceport or City to take a face-up Advanced BAC card from the Advanced BAC Area. When a card is taken, refill that slot from the top of the Advanced BAC Deck. Prerequisites: C.A.P Chest -> S.A.P Chest, C.A.P Head -> S.A.P Helmet, C.A.P Legs -> S.A.P Legs, L.P.M -> B.A.S.R or S.L.I.M.E, P.A.E.H -> H.C.A.R. To equip a C.A.P, trade in the corresponding S.A.P piece (detach it from the mini and return it to the supply) as part of the upgrade cost, then attach the C.A.P module.
- Armor Stacking: S.A.P and C.A.P pieces each grant their defense bonus independently (+1 per S.A.P piece, +2 per C.A.P piece). There are no set bonuses — equip as many or as few armor pieces as your strategy demands.
- Tapping: Some modules are Tapped (rotated 90° on the mini or marked with a tap token) when activated. A Tapped module cannot be used again until Untapped (recharged) — typically at a City or Spaceport for a resource cost.
- One-Shot: Modules marked as one-use (e.g., D.U.D.S) are removed from the soldier after activation, freeing the slot. The module is returned to the supply and no longer counts toward DP.

Activating Modules

Modules with active abilities fall into two timing categories:

Category	When to Activate	Examples
Combat Modules	During combat resolution at Step 3 (equipment bonuses)	N.I.N.J.A (Nir Ion Nullifier Jammer Aid; +3 defense die)
Field Modules	During a Logistics action on your turn	P.L.A.S.T.E.R (Personal Lasting Aid Surgical Treatment Enhancement Robot; heal damage), D.U.D.S (place bunker)

- Untapping (recharging) a Tapped module is also done during a Logistics action. The soldier must be at the required location (City or Spaceport) and you must pay the listed recharge cost.
- Passive bonuses (e.g., H.C.A.R +1 attack, S.A.P +1 defense) are always active and require no activation — they apply automatically during combat.

Full BAC Card List (20 Types × 5 Copies = 100 Cards)

Note: The 5 Level 2 types (marked +) are only available from the Advanced BAC Deck, not the Spaceport Deck. You must unlock the corresponding prerequisite BAC type before acquiring them: C.A.P Chest -> S.A.P Chest, C.A.P Head -> S.A.P Helmet, C.A.P Legs -> S.A.P Legs, L.P.M -> B.A.S.R or S.L.I.M.E, P.A.E.H -> H.C.A.R.

Category	Abbr	Full Name	Slot	Cost	DP	Effect
Armor	S.A.P Chest	Standard Armor Plating Chest Piece	Chest	1 Oil, 1 Industry	1	This soldier gets +1 to its defense die
	S.A.P Helmet	Standard Armor Plating Helmet	Head	1 Oil, 1 Industry	1	This soldier gets +1 to its defense die
	S.A.P Legs	Standard Armor Plating Legs	Legs	1 Oil, 1 Industry	1	This soldier gets +1 to its defense die
Armor +	C.A.P Chest	Custom Armor Plating Chest	Chest	1 S.A.P Chest + 1 LF, 1 Ind, 1 Oil	4	This soldier gets +2 to its defense die
+	C.A.P Head	Custom Armor Plating Helmet	Head	1 S.A.P Head + 1 LF, 1 Int, 1 Oil	4	This soldier gets +2 to its defense die
+	C.A.P Legs	Custom Armor Plating Legs	Legs	1 S.A.P Legs + 1 LF, 1 Elec, 1 Oil	4	This soldier gets +2 to its defense die
Weapons	H.C.A.R	Heavy Caliber Assault Rifle	Hands	1 Ind, 1 Oil	2	Range 1. +1 attack die
	R.S.G	Repeating Shotgun	Hands	1 Oil, 1 LF	2	Range 1. Same hex as target: +2 attack. Not same hex: -1 attack
	P.C.S.M.G	Projectile Correcting Sub Machine Gun	Hands	1 Elec, 1 Ind, 1 Int	3	Range 1. Same hex: roll 3d6 pick highest
Heavy	B.A.S.R	Bolt Action Sniper Rifle	Hands	1 Oil, 1 Int, 1 Ind	4	Range 2. Pre-combat: 2d6 pick higher, target 1 soldier in range. Sniper skips combat. Both get -1 defense
	S.L.I.M.E	Squad Light Interoperable Mortar Encampment	Backpack	1 Ind, 2 Oil, 2 LF	5	2-soldier crew. 4d6 normal matchups, target squad up to 3 hexes. Crew skips combat. -1 defense. Civilian Damage Rule
Support	P.L.A.S.T.E.R	Personal Lasting Aid Surgical Treatment Enhancement Robot	Chest	1 Elec, 1 LF	2	Heal up to 2 damage on any soldier same hex. Tap. Recharge: 1 Elec
	B.E.A.R	Battlefield Extraction Airlift Rover	Chest	1 Oil, 1 Ind, 1 Elec	3	Its occupied resource hex provides +1 token during Phase 3; does not stack
Support +	L.P.M	Laser Pointer Marker	Backpack	1 Elec, 1 LF, 1 Int	4	B.A.S.R/S.L.I.M.E target enemies near L.P.M carrier. Max 4 hex
	D.U.D.S	Deployable Unital Defense System	Backpack	1 LF, 1 Oil, 1 Ind	2	Place bunker: +1 all defense dice. One-use, frees slot. 2 DP deploy + 2 DP to hex controller
Tech	J.J	Jump Jets	Legs	1 Ind, 1 Int	2	Move 2 hexes. May override coherency (fights alone)
	S.H.A.D	Sensory Helmet, Advisory Drone	Head	2 Int, 1 Elec	5	Attacker must reveal Conspire cards before combat
Tech +	P.A.E.H	Personal Accuracy Enhancement Helmet	Head	1 LF, 1 Elec, 1 Int	4	+1 attack die while also equipped with H.C.A.R
	N.I.N.J.A	Nir Ion Nullifier Jammer Aid	Legs	1 Int, 1 Elec	2	+3 to one defense die. Tap. Recharge: 2 Elec
	T.I.L.T.S	Tactical Ion Team Link Shield	Backpack	1 Elec, 1 Ind, 2 Int	5	Adjacent T.I.L.T.S pair swap one attacker die. Always active. No other backpack

CONSPIRING

A player may spend one of a Squad's 2 actions to Conspire.

Drawing Conspire Cards

- 1. Draw 3 cards from the Conspire Deck.
- 2. Keep 1 card, discard the other 2 face-down.
- 3. If a drawn card states otherwise (e.g., "keep 2"), follow that card's instructions.

A single Squad may Conspire twice in the same turn (spending both actions), drawing twice.

Hand Limit: A player may hold a maximum of 7 Conspire Cards. At the end of your turn, if you have more than 7, discard down to 7 (your choice which to discard).

Playing Conspire Cards

Conspire Cards fall into two timing categories:

Combat Cards (Guerrilla Warfare, Defender Instant Shield, Old School RPG, One Pulse Barrier):

- Played only during combat at Step 4 of combat resolution.
- Defender plays first, then Attacker responds.
- Each player may play any number of eligible Combat Conspire Cards.

Tactical Cards (all other Conspire Cards — resource exchange, free resource, territory control, etc.):

- May be played at any time — during your turn, another player's turn, or between phases.
- Effects resolve instantly.

Pay any listed cost when you play the card.

Deck Exhaustion

When the Conspire Deck is empty, shuffle the discard pile to form a new deck.

Full Conspire Card List (24 Types × 3 Copies = 72 Cards)

Resource Exchange (Free to Play; Exchange 1 -> Gain 3)

Name	Cost	Effect	Copies
Abandoned Satellite Control Station	Free	Exchange 1 Electricity for 3 Intelligence	3
Build a Wind Farm	Free	Exchange 1 Industry for 3 Electricity	3
Raid an Oil Cache	Free	Exchange 1 Intelligence for 3 Oil	3
Factory Takeover	Free	Exchange 1 Local Favor for 3 Industry	3
Build a Follower Camp	Free	Exchange 1 Industry for 3 Local Favor	3

Free Resource (Gain 1, Chance for Bonus)

Name	Cost	Effect	Copies
Recruit Eager Volunteers	Free	Gain 1 Local Favor. Roll d6: on 5–6, gain 1 additional resource token of any type you choose	3
Scout Ahead	Free	Gain 1 Intelligence. Roll d6: on 5–6, gain 1 additional resource token of any type you choose	3
Tap into Oil Reserves	Free	Gain 1 Oil. Roll d6: on 5–6, gain 1 additional resource token of any type you choose	3
Proper Planning	Free	Gain 1 Industry. Roll d6: on 5–6, gain 1 additional resource token of any type you choose	3
Tap into the Local Power Grid	Free	Gain 1 Electricity. Roll d6: on 5–6, gain 1 additional resource token of any type you choose	3

Combat

Name	Cost	Effect	Copies
Guerrilla Warfare	1 Local Favor	Add 1d6 to an attack combat roll	3
Defender Instant Shield	1 Oil	Add 1d6 to a defense combat roll	3
Old School RPG	Free	+1 to an attack combat roll	3
One Pulse Barrier	Free	+1 to a defense combat roll	3

Tactical

Name	Cost	Effect	Copies
Deal with Local Militia	3 Local Favor	Spawn 3 militia on a hex within 2 hexes of your soldier. They immediately attack one adjacent enemy Squad, then are removed (see Militia Rules below)	3
A Rough Night	1 Local Favor, 2 Intelligence	Target any Squad: immobilized AND -1 combat rolls next turn	3
Traveling Med Bay	X resources (X <= 3)	Exchange any 1 resource to heal 1 damage peg. Repeat up to 3×	3
Deal with a Local Representative	1 any resource	Conspire again, keep 2 cards instead of 1	3
Hack a PortNet Relay	1 Intelligence	Take 1 face-up BAC from the Planet Bound Area into your hand. Immediately refill the empty slot from the Spaceport Deck	3

Territory Control (Require Controlling 2+ of a Resource Type)

Name	Condition	Effect	Copies
Knowledge is Power	Control 2+ Intelligence tiles	Gain 2 BACs from Spaceport Deck	3
Civilian Goods Transport	Control 2+ Local Favor tiles	Gain any 4 resource tokens	3
Black Gold Syndicate	Control 2+ Oil tiles	Draw 2 Conspire cards (keep both)	3
At the Cover of Darkness	Control 2+ Electricity tiles	Steal from opponent: 2 resources, OR 1 Conspire, OR 1 BAC	3
Factory Cost Savings	Control 2+ Industry tiles	Equip a BAC free for 2 soldiers. Pay normal cost for rest	3

MILITIA

Militia are temporary local fighters summoned by the Deal with Local Militia Conspire Card. They are not a permanent force — they attack once and disperse.

Rule	Detail
Spawning	Place 3 militia on a hex within 2 hexes of one of your soldiers. Spawning is mandatory — the card effect cannot be partially resolved
Components	Use spare Separatist miniatures. If none are available, use any substitute (coins, tokens, dice, etc.)
Combat	Militia immediately attack one adjacent enemy Squad using normal combat rules
Dice Penalty	-1 to all dice (same as Separatists)
Hit Points	1 life each — any hit kills instantly
No Equipment	Militia carry no BACs and have no equipment slots
Dispersal	All militia are removed from the board after their attack resolves, regardless of outcome

Note: Militia act on the summoning player's behalf — the summoning player assigns their attack dice and chooses matchups.

CONTROLLING TERRITORY

Claiming a Hex

Claim is resolved automatically immediately after each Move action and each Combat action — see the Claim Hexes sub-steps in each phase. The rule in both places:

For every hex containing one or more of your soldiers and no enemy soldiers, place one of your Control Flags on that hex. If an opposing flag is already there, return it to that opponent's supply and replace it with yours. If your own flag is already there, leave it.

This applies to resource-producing hexes, Spaceport Drop Zones, Separatist Bases (once conquered — all 7 defenders killed), and Terrain hexes.

Once placed, a flag stays even after your Squad leaves — the hex remains under your control until an opponent's Squad enters it and re-claims it via the same Move or Combat action. Contested hexes (both your and an enemy's soldiers on the same hex) skip flag placement until a Combat action resolves the occupant.

Territory DP: Each hex you claim (excluding your Landing Zones) is worth +1 DP — add it to your DP counter immediately when you place your flag. If an opponent later takes that hex from you, subtract 1 DP from your total and the opponent adds 1 DP to theirs. Your Landing Zones (where your starting Squads deployed) are free territory and give 0 DP.

End-of-Round Bonus

Important: This happens at the END OF THE ROUND — after ALL players have completed their turns. It does NOT happen at the end of each individual player's turn.

At the end of each round (after all players have completed their turns), any uncollected resource tokens on your controlled hexes are added to your supply. Additionally, any spaceport hexes you control with container markers grant you the BAC cards from the matching Unloading Zone slot. See the End of Round step in the Turn Structure for full details.

Territory collection is resolved simultaneously for all players once the final player's turn (including Phase 4) is complete.

HOW TO WIN

Three paths lead to victory. When any player meets a victory condition, the Final Round is triggered — the current round becomes the last round. All players who have not yet taken their turn this round still take it. At the end of the Final Round, the winner is determined (see Final Round Resolution below).

Victory 1: Spaceport Domination

Fully control the required number of Spaceport Landing Zones:

Players	Spaceports Needed
2	5 of 6
3–4	4 of 6

A Spaceport is under your full control when your Control Hex Frame is on it and no enemy soldiers occupy the hex. A Spaceport with enemy soldiers on it is contested and does not count toward the threshold.

Your corporate HQ dispatches a full battalion. With the majority of orbital access locked down, rival corporations can no longer resupply — they flee off-world in panic. You win command of the planet.

Victory 2: Military Supremacy

Have more than double the soldiers in play of the next largest player's army.

Count all living soldiers each player has on the board. If your soldier count is strictly more than 2× the count of the player with the second-largest army, you trigger the Final Round. Exactly 2× does not trigger — you need to exceed it.

Example: You have 14 soldiers. The other players have 4, 5, and 6. The second-largest army is 6. $6 \times 2 = 12$. You have 14, which is more than 12 — triggered. If the second-largest had 7 instead, $7 \times 2 = 14$ and you have 14 — not triggered (ties don't count).

Your overwhelming military presence renders further conflict pointless. Rival HQs withdraw. You are promoted to conquer bigger, richer planets.

Victory 3: Dominance

Accumulate 50 Dominance Points (DP).

DP come from four sources:

1. Equipped BAC cards — each BAC's DP value counts toward your total as long as the card remains equipped and the soldier carrying it is alive.
2. Battle Victory DP — after each combat, the side that inflicted more wounds than they received earns DP equal to the difference, up to 3 DP per battle (see Combat Step 8). This DP is permanent.
3. Territory DP — each hex you claim (excluding your Landing Zones) is worth +1 DP. If an opponent takes that hex from you, you lose 1 DP and they gain 1 DP (see Claiming a Hex).
4. Bunker DP — deploying a D.U.D.S bunker grants the deployer 2 DP (permanent). Whoever controls the bunkered hex earns an additional 2 DP. Total: 4 DP for a deployer holding their own bunker (see Bunker Rules).

The local population rallies behind your banner and crowns you their sovereign.

Dominion Points Tracking

Adjust your DP counter immediately whenever any of the following events occur. The table lists every DP source, exactly when to add or remove points, and whether the DP is permanent.

DP Source	Add DP When...	Remove DP When...	Permanent?
BAC Card DP	You unlock a new BAC type (first soldier equipped) or equip an additional soldier with an already-unlocked BAC — add the card's DP value per soldier equipped.	A soldier dies and their module is destroyed (returned to box) or salvaged by another player — subtract that module's DP. If the owner keeps the module (salvage pick 1) and re-attaches it, no DP change occurs.	No — flows with equipment
Battle Victory DP	After combat Step 8, your side inflicted more wounds than you received — add the difference, up to 3 DP. Both attacker and defender are eligible.	Never. Battle Victory DP is permanent and does not go away if soldiers are later lost.	Yes — permanent
Territory DP	You place your Control Flag on a hex (excluding Landing Zones) — add 1 DP immediately.	An opponent takes a hex from you (replaces your flag with theirs) — subtract 1 DP; the opponent adds 1 DP. Landing Zones give 0 DP and never change.	No — flows with territory
Bunker DP	D.U.D.S deployed — deployer adds 2 DP immediately. The player who controls the bunkered hex adds 2 DP (total 4 DP for deployer holding their own bunker).	If hex control changes, the previous controller subtracts 2 DP and the new controller adds 2 DP. The deployer's 2 DP deployment bonus is never lost.	Deployment: permanent. Hex control: flows with territory

Summary: Only Battle Victory DP and the Bunker deployment bonus are truly permanent. BAC Card DP and Territory DP (including Bunker hex-control DP) go up and down as soldiers die, hexes change hands, and equipment is lost or salvaged.

Final Round Resolution

When a player meets any victory condition during their turn, the current round becomes the Final Round. All players who have not yet taken their turn this round still take it. At the end of the Final Round:

1. Check which players meet any victory condition.
2. If one player meets a condition, they win.
3. If multiple players meet conditions, the player with the highest DP wins.
4. If no player meets a condition (e.g., it was contested during the Final Round), the player with the highest DP wins.
5. If DP is tied, play additional rounds until the tie is broken.

QUICK REFERENCE CARD

Soldier Equipment Slots

Die Roll	Slot
1	Head
2	Backpack
3	Legs
4–5	Chest
6	Hands

Resource Colors

Resource	Color	Depiction	Hex Tile	Token
Oil	Black	Fuel	Oil Rig	Oil Drum
Electricity	Yellow	Electricity Bolt	Power Plant	Lightning Bolt
Intelligence	Blue	Intel Operator Room	Radar Dish	Transmitting Wave
Industry	Red	Industry Factory	Factory	Hammer
Local Favor	Green	Militia Base	City / Village	Recruit

Turn Phase Summary

#	Phase	Key Action
1	Resource Production	Roll 3d6, place resource tokens on matching hexes
2	Activation Phase	Each Squad takes 2 actions: Move, Combat, Logistics, Conspire, or Rest
3	Salvage & Resource Gathering	Collect salvage, then 1 token per distinct resource hex occupied by your Squads
4	Separatists	Uprising -> consume -> move toward producing hexes -> resolve combats

Key Costs

Action	Cost	Location
Recruit 1 Soldier	1 Local Favor + 1 Oil + 1 Industry + 1 Electricity	City
Create New Squad (min 5)	5× soldier cost	City
Draw from Spaceport Deck	3 same-type resource tokens	Spaceport or City
Conspire	Costs 1 of the Squad's 2 actions	Anywhere
Untap P.L.A.S.T.E.R	1 Electricity	City or Spaceport
Untap N.I.N.J.A	2 Electricity	City or Spaceport

Combat Quick Reference

Step	Action
0	Pre-Combat: S.H.A.D reveal, pre-combat cards, B.A.S.R & S.L.I.M.E attacks
1	Both sides roll 1d6 per engaged soldier. Larger side picks best dice
2	Attacker assigns dice to defenders; Defender aligns defense dice
3	Apply equipment bonuses (+attack, +defense)
4	Play Combat Conspire Cards (defender first, then attacker)
5	Attack > Defense = HIT (difference = damage). 4 damage = death -> roll d6 for slot -> salvage
6	Defense beats attack by 2+ = Counterattack (chains naturally until a roll fails to trigger)
7	Defender Withdrawal: defender may move surviving soldiers 1 hex away (free)
8	Battle Victory DP: side that inflicted more wounds earns DP = difference, up to 3

Victory Conditions

Path	Condition
Spaceport Domination	Fully control 4 of 6 Spaceports (2-player: 5 of 6)
Military Supremacy	More than 2× the soldiers of the next largest army (strictly more)
Dominance	Accumulate 50 DP from equipped BACs + Battle Victory DP + Territory DP + Bunker DP
Final Round	Any condition met -> finish the round -> highest DP breaks ties

Name your world. Deploy your H.A.M.S. Fight for Dominance.

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